



Social Media Code of Conduct

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Intent

CPCS strives to maintain a positive image in the community and has adopted this policy to ensure that our staff members are aware of their responsibility to maintain a positive image as a representative of our organization. CPCS employees, associates and exclusives associates that maintain personal social media pages (e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn, Blogs, Twitter, MySpace, etc.) are expected to comply with the guidelines set out within this policy.

Definition

Social Media is forms of electronic communication through which users create online communities to share information, ideas, personal messages and other content (Merriam-Webster Dictionary). These include, but are not limited to: Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, Myspace.

General Guidelines

CPCS staff members who maintain personal social media pages or accounts are required to comply with the following guidelines as they relate to their association with CPCS. Employees will be held accountable for what they write or post on social media or internet pages.

Employees should follow the guidelines below when making posts or comments on any social media site, whether it is public or private.

- Employees are prohibited from making inflammatory comments, unprofessional remarks or disparaging remarks made about the organization, its employees, customers, vendors or competitors.
- Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally during and outside of business hours. Where a staff member publically associates with the company, all materials associated with their page may reflect on the company. Please be advised that inappropriate comments, photographs, links, etc. should be avoided. You must ensure that your profile and related content is consistent with how you wish to present yourself with colleagues and clients.
- Posts involving the following will not be tolerated and will subject the individual to discipline:
 - Proprietary and confidential company, client, partner or supplier information.
 - Discriminatory statements or sexual innuendos regarding co-workers, management, customers or vendors.
 - Defamatory statements regarding the company, its employees, customers, competitors or vendors.
 - Company business performance or other sensitive matters about business results or plans.
- Employees that use these sites are prohibited from disseminating any private organizational information therein, or any negative comments regarding the organization.
- Where an employee mentions the company, projects or services, they will be required to include a disclaimer stating that any opinions expressed are the employee's own and do not represent the company's positions, strategies or opinions.
- CPCS staff and associates are prohibited from speaking on behalf of the organization, releasing confidential information, releasing news or communicating as a representative of the organization without prior authorization to act as a designated CPCS representative.
- Use of personal social media may not conflict with any of CPCS's existing policies whatsoever. This includes, but is not limited to, the [IT Systems Policy](#) and the [Internet Usage Agreement](#).
- Employees are prohibited from using social media during regular working hours, employees should limit its use to official breaks, (i.e. meal breaks). The use of social media should not have a negative impact on user productivity or

efficiency. As internet access at CPCS is monitored, please be advised that excessive use of social media for personal reasons is a misappropriation of company time and resources, and may be subject to disciplinary action.

- Company policies governing the use of copyright materials, corporate logos and other forms of branding and identity apply to electronic communications. Employees are prohibited from using CPCS protected materials (copyright material, branding and/or logo(s)) without prior express written permission.
- Employees are required to respect copyrights and never post text, images or video created by someone else without proper attribution and/or authorization. If employees have questions about copyright law and/or the usage of certain media, they may contact Benoit Laplante.
- CPCS strictly prohibits the use of company-owned computer resources for use in the illegal download or upload of copyright materials without express written permission and authorization from the copyright holder.
- Do not cite or reference clients, partners or suppliers on business-related matters without their approval. When you do make a reference, link back to the source and do not publish content that might allow inferences to be drawn which could damage a client relationship with CPCS.
- Social media is not a substitute for inter-company communications. Important information should be transmitted within normal company communication channels (i.e. the company's email platform), and not through social media outlets.

This policy is not intended to interfere with the private lives of our staff members or impinge their right to freedom of speech. This policy is designed to ensure that CPCS's image and branding are maintained.

Employees should abide by these guidelines whether they mention the company by name or not. Even if the name is not mentioned in a post, it is possible a link can be made back to the company which can negatively affect the company's reputation. Where a link can be made between a negative or inflammatory post and the Company, even if not named directly, the employee may be subject to disciplinary action.

Any employee who fails to follow the guidelines set out in this policy may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Tips and Additional Guidelines

- It is best practice and recommended that communication regarding CPCS business be moved from social media to the outlook platform for record keeping purposes.
- In the event that a CPCS employee discovers any group(s) that users have formed to discuss the company, its products or services, employees are requested to bring them to the attention of management.
- Respect your audience. Do not use ethnic slurs, discriminatory remarks, personal insults, obscenity, or engage in any similar conduct that would not be appropriate or acceptable in CPCS's workplace. You should also show proper consideration for others' privacy.
- Employees should always carefully consider what to post in response to an argumentative or accusatory post. If employees have any questions regarding how to respond to a particular post, employees should discuss the issue with management prior to posting.
- Try to add value. Provide worthwhile information and perspective. CPCS is best represented by its people and what you publish may reflect on CPCS.